DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

One verse, two clocks

Jev score: 0.66 — Jev (jev-1.13.0): does the source illuminate the daf in a non-obvious way, beyond merely being cited by it?

The daf's engine is the verse it never stops turning: "You shall not put off the skimming of the first yield of your vats... the firstborn of your sons you shall give Me. So you shall do with your oxen and your sheep" (Exodus 22:28-29). From a single juxtaposition the Gemara extracts two different waiting periods — thirty days for sheep and goats, yoked to the thirty-day redemption of the firstborn son (Numbers 18:16), and fifty for cattle, yoked to the fifty days of the Omer count to Shavuot (Leviticus 23:15).

Jev scored this 0.66, the strongest of the week — and the reason is structural, not decorative. The verse does not merely authorize the waiting periods; it builds the daf's whole economy of firsts, binding harvest, sons, and animals into one "do not delay" obligation. The non-obvious part is the Gemara's audacity in reading two different clocks out of one line, then defending the mapping against its own reversal objection.

PARSHA · NOACH

No strong link this week

Jev score: 0.50 — Jev (jev-1.13.0): how strongly is the candidate grounded in the actual texts of the daf and the parsha?

Honesty first: there is no strong daf-parsha connection this week, and the scores say so plainly. The best candidate, at 0.5, is a shared root — Malachi's "you have corrupted (shichatem) the covenant of Levi," the daf's hammer against priests who monetize holy gifts, against the flood generation of whom "all flesh had corrupted (hishchit) its way upon the earth" (Genesis 6:12). A real lexical echo, but two different corruptions: priests turning sacred dues into wages versus a world filled with violence.

Rejected by Jev: Noah's clean animals vs. the blemish divide (0.39); the ark's year of tending vs. the 30/50-day periods (0.37); the expert inspector vs. clean/unclean discernment (0.35); chamas vs. sacred wages (0.42); Noah's righteousness vs. integrity in transfers (0.34)

NEWS CHECK

No genuine resonance this week

Jev score: 0.27 — Jev (jev-1.13.0): does the story resonate meaningfully with the daf's themes, or is the link forced?

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

The daf's world — consecrated animals, the expert's inspection of blemishes, the sanctity of priestly dues — sits far from this week's headlines, and Jev was strict about it. The closest it would go was 0.27, for the Djibouti migrant tragedy via the daf's protest against treating the sacred as instrumental, and 0.25 for Ukraine's $59B aid shortfall via diverted funds. Both are stretches. A week with no news link is a finding, not a failure.

MAAGARIM · BEKHOR

בכור: 3,715 attestations, from Abel's flock to the modern eldest son

The word enters the Historical Dictionary with Abel: "והבל הביא גם הוא מבכרות צאנו" (Genesis 4:4) — the first of 2,551 citations, root בכר, first-ripening. Midway through the sweep comes a Geonic burst that is the daf's own world: runs of הלכות פסוקות (Rav Yehudai Gaon, d. 761) and הלכות ראו (750-800 CE) on the firstborn's double portion, bekhor behemah, blemish inspection, and priestly gifts.

Then the arc bends: from consecrated animal the word narrows to the eldest son. The final page lands in modern literary Hebrew — Berdichevsky's 1921 "הקדיש עתותיו ללמודי התלמוד הבכור" and Shami's 1927 "סטר על לחיי בכורו." The sanctity of firstness survives the Temple's loss by migrating from the animal to the child.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language.

929 · I KINGS 7 (CH. 294)

Two houses, thirteen years, and the motto in bronze

51 verses

The chapter is a diptych of two houses, told in reverse order. Verses 1-12 describe Solomon's own building project — his palace, the House of the Forest of Lebanon (a cedar forest brought indoors), the Hall of Pillars, the throne hall where he judged, and a house for Pharaoh's daughter — and only then, in verses 13-51, the furnishings of God's house. The narrative order is the reverse of the building order: the palace was finished second, after thirteen years to the Temple's seven, and the chapter returns to the Temple to close.

Rashi hears the thirteen years as praise, not apology: "הכתוב, ובשלו נתעצל, שבמלאכת גבוה נזדרז ובשבחו ספר" — in the work of the Most High he hurried, in his own he was lazy, and Scripture recounts it in his honor. Radak works the chronology harder: the thirteen years began after God's house was complete, and he preserves an alternative reading — the years are regnal years, with only about two spent on his own house — so that "at the end of twenty years" (v. 51) accounts for both: seven and thirteen.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

The chapter's hinge is Hiram of Tyre, the bronze-worker "filled with wisdom, understanding, and knowledge" (7:14) — the exact triad of Bezalel at the Tabernacle (Exodus 31:3). Kings deliberately casts him as a second Bezalel; the bronze court is a second Tabernacle, and the literary device is unmistakable once you hear the echo.

Hiram's two pillars carry the chapter's most quotable image: Jachin (יכין, "He will establish") on the right, Boaz (בעז, "in strength") on the left (7:21) — a complete sentence, the Davidic throne's motto cast in bronze at the Temple porch, their capitals wreathed with networks of pomegranates. Behind them the molten sea rests on twelve oxen facing the four winds (7:25): the twelve tribes bearing the waters of purification, cosmic order in cast metal. The ten stands are engraved with lions, oxen, cherubim, and palms (7:29, 36) — the guardian creatures of the ark's own cherubim, now mobile.

The repeated keyword is בית — house. The chapter counts them obsessively, and cedar is the thread stitching palace to Temple: Lebanon's glory paneling both. The closing verse (7:51) subordinates everything: with all the work complete, Solomon brings in "the sacred donations of his father David" — silver, gold, vessels. The chapter that began with Solomon's own house ends by folding it into David's consecrated treasure. The son completes the father's vow; the book's arc, in one verse.

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:15-16

The geometry of impurity

2 mishnayot

Oholot 9:15

אָרוֹן שֶׁהִיא רְחָבָה מִלְּמַטָּן וְצָרָה מִלְּמַעְלָן וְהַמֵּת בְּתוֹכָהּ, הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּהּ מִלְּמַטָּן, טָהוֹר. וּמִלְּמַעְלָן, טָמֵא. רְחָבָה מִלְּמַעְלָן וְצָרָה מִלְּמַטָּן, הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּהּ מִכָּל מָקוֹם, טָמֵא. הָיְתָה שָׁוָה, הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּהּ מִכָּל מָקוֹם, טָמֵא, דִּבְרֵי רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר. וְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אוֹמֵר, מִטֶּפַח וּלְמַטָּן, טָהוֹר. מִטֶּפַח וּלְמַעְלָן, טָמֵא. הָעֲשׂוּיָה כְּמִין קַמְטְרָא, הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּהּ מִכָּל מָקוֹם, טָמֵא. כְּמִין גְּלוֹסְקוֹס, הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּהּ מִכָּל מָקוֹם, טָהוֹר, חוּץ מִמְּקוֹם פְּתִיחָתָהּ׃

A coffin which is broad below and narrow above, and has a corpse within it: one who touches it below remains pure; above, impure. Broad above and narrow below: touching it anywhere — impure. If it was uniform, touching it anywhere — impure, the words of Rabbi Eliezer; Rabbi Joshua says: a handbreadth and below — pure; a handbreadth and above — impure. If made like a kamtra (chest), touching it anywhere — impure. Like a gluskos (case), touching it anywhere — pure, except at the place of its opening.

Rambam: the Tosefta's case is a coffin hewn in rock — touching it anywhere is pure except opposite the covering, like a great pit full of corpses with a stone over its mouth. The kamtra is the Egyptian wardrobe (he notes it is well known 'among us, i.e. in Egypt, as al-kamtra'; cf. II Kings 10's hamelethachah); the gluskos is like a box with a side opening, like a burial niche in the rock — impure only opposite its opening, on the

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

model of the Tosefta's pit.

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Goldberg ties this mishnah to its predecessor via the Tosefta on the beehive-coffin, and Neusner observes that the entire next chapter is about 'impurity opposite' (טומאה כנגד) — so this mishnah opens that discussion. Realia note: ארון carries two senses, the wooden storage chest for vessels and garments and the coffin.

Oholot 9:16

חָבִית שֶׁהִיא יוֹשֶׁבֶת עַל שׁוּלֶיהָ בָּאֲוִיר וְכַזַּיִת מִן הַמֵּת נָתוּן תַּחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ בְתוֹכָהּ כְּנֶגֶד קוּרְקוּרָתָהּ, טֻמְאָה בּוֹקַעַת וְעוֹלָה, בּוֹקַעַת וְיוֹרֶדֶת, וְהֶחָבִית טְמֵאָה. תַּחַת דָּפְנָהּ מִבַּחוּץ, טֻמְאָה בּוֹקַעַת וְעוֹלָה, בּוֹקַעַת וְיוֹרֶדֶת, וְהֶחָבִית טְהוֹרָה. בְּתוֹכָהּ וְתַחַת דָּפְנָהּ, אִם יֵשׁ בַּדְּפָנוֹת פּוֹתֵחַ טֶפַח, הַכֹּל טָמֵא, וּכְנֶגֶד פִּיהָ, טָהוֹר. וְאִם לָאו, טֻמְאָה בּוֹקַעַת וְעוֹלָה, בּוֹקַעַת וְיוֹרֶדֶת. בַּמֶּה דְּבָרִים אֲמוּרִים, בִּטְהוֹרָה. אֲבָל אִם הָיְתָה טְמֵאָה אוֹ גְּבוֹהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח אוֹ מְכֻסָּה אוֹ כְפוּיָה עַל פִּיהָ, טֻמְאָה תַּחְתֶּיהָ, בְּתוֹכָהּ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא:

A jar resting on its base in the open air, with an olive's bulk of corpse-matter beneath it or inside it opposite its bottom: impurity cleaves upward and cleaves downward, and the jar is impure. Beneath its side-wall, outside: impurity cleaves upward and downward, and the jar is pure. Inside it and beneath its side: if the walls have a handbreadth opening, all is impure, but opposite its mouth — pure; if not, impurity cleaves upward and downward. These words apply to a pure jar; but if it was impure, or a handbreadth off the ground, or covered, or inverted on its mouth — impurity beneath it, inside it, or on top of it renders all impure.

Rambam: 'opposite its bottom' means the impurity lies under the jar's hollow, not under the thickness of its walls; 'cleaves upward and downward' applies where the impurity is constricted to less than a handbreadth. An earthenware vessel is not rendered impure from its outside but from its airspace — so impurity under the side-wall, outside the hollow, leaves the jar pure. He calls this 'among the subtleties of the matter.'

Mishnat Eretz Yisrael: Archaeological realia: ancient jars were made with pointed bottoms and set leaning or in stands; a flat base is weaker (it must be joined to the body) but more convenient. The חבית is the standard storage jar of our literature, with a small base, swelling walls, a narrow neck, and the 'shoulders' (הוגנים) between body and neck.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT NA'ARAH BETULAH 2

The tariff of violation — and its loophole

17 halachot

Halachah 1

חֲמִשִּׁים כֶּסֶף שֶׁל קְנָס הֵם דְּמֵי הֲנָאַת שְׁכִיבָה בִּלְבַד. וְחַיָּב הַמְפַתֶּה לִתֵּן בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם יוֹתֵר עַל הַקְּנָס הַקָּצוּב בַּתּוֹרָה. יֶתֶר עָלָיו הָאוֹנֵס שֶׁהוּא נוֹתֵן אֶת הַצַּעַר. שֶׁהַנִּבְעֶלֶת בִּרְצוֹנָהּ אֵין לָהּ צַעַר וַאֲנוּסָה יֵשׁ לָהּ צַעַר. וְכֵן הוּא אוֹמֵר בַּאֲנוּסָה (דברים כב כט) "תַּחַת אֲשֶׁר עִנָּהּ":

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

The fine of 50 silver pieces represents merely the payment for the pleasure of sexual relations. In addition, a seducer is obligated to pay for embarrassment and damages in addition to the fixed amount mentioned by the Torah. A rapist, moreover, also pays for the pain [he caused the girl]. [A seducer is not required to make this payment,] because a girl who willingly engages in relations does not [suffer] pain. A girl who is raped does, as reflected by [Deuteronomy 22:29]: "because he violated her."

Halachah 2

נִמְצָא הַמְפַתֶּה מְשַׁלֵּם שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים קְנָס וּבֹשֶׁת וּפְגָם. וְהָאוֹנֵס אַרְבָּעָה קְנָס וּבֹשֶׁת וְצַעַר וּפְגָם׃

Thus, a seducer makes three payments: the fine, and compensation for embarrassment and damages. A rapist makes four payments: the fine, and compensation for embarrassment, pain and damages.

Halachah 3

קְנָס שָׁוֶה בַּכֹּל. אֶחָד הַבָּא עַל בַּת כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל וְאֶחָד הַבָּא עַל בַּת גֵּר אוֹ מַמְזֵר קְנָסָהּ חֲמִשִּׁים כֶּסֶף. אֲבָל הַבּשֶׁת וְהַפְּגָם וְהַצַּעַר אֵינָן שָׁוִין לַכֹּל וּצְרִיכִין שׁוּמָא׃

The fine is the same in all instances. Whether one has relations with the daughter of the High Priest, or the daughter of a convert or a bastard, the fine is 50 silver pieces. The amount paid for embarrassment, damages and pain is not uniform, however. Instead, the amount must be evaluated [by the court].

Halachah 4

כֵּיצַד שָׁמִין הַבּשֶׁת. הַכֹּל לְפִי הַמְבַיֵּשׁ וְהַמִּתְבַּיֵּשׁ. שֶׁאֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה מְבַיֵּשׁ נַעֲרָה חֲשׁוּבָה וּמִמְשְׁפָּחָה מְיֻחָסָה לְמְבַיֵּשׁ קְטַנָּה עֲנִיָּה בְּזוּיָה. וְאֵינוֹ דּוֹמֶה מִתְבַּיֵּשׁ מֵאָדָם חָשׁוּב וְגָדוֹל לְמִתְבַּיֵּשׁ מֵאֶחָד מֵהַנִּבְלִים וְקַל מִן הַקַּלִּים׃

How is this evaluation made? With regard to embarrassment, everything is dependent on the identity of the person who is embarrassed, and the identity of the person who embarrasses her. The embarrassment suffered by a girl of high repute from a family of known lineage cannot be compared to the embarrassment suffered by a poor, ignoble maiden. And the embarrassment suffered at the hands of an important person of great stature cannot be compared to that suffered at the hands of a base and empty fellow.

Halachah 5

וּלְפִי זֶה רוֹאִין הַדַּיָּנִין מַעֲלָתוֹ וּמַעֲלָתָהּ וְשָׁמִין כַּמָּה מָמוֹן רָאוּי לְאָבִיהָ וּלְמִשְׁפַּחְתָּהּ לִתֵּן וְלֹא יֵאָרַע לָהֶן דָּבָר זֶה מֵאָדָם זֶה וְכָמוֹהוּ חַיָּב לְשַׁלֵּם׃

On this basis, the judges consider the stature of [the rapist or the seducer] and his victim. They evaluate how much a father and the girl's family would give to prevent [these

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

relations] from taking place with this individual. This is the amount [the man] is obligated to pay.

Halachah 6

פְּגָם לְפִי יָפְיָהּ. רוֹאִין אוֹתָהּ כְּאִלּוּ הִיא שִׁפְחָה נִמְכֶּרֶת בַּשּׁוּק כַּמָּה הִיא שָׁוָה בְּעוּלָה וְכַמָּה הָיְתָה שָׁוָה בְּתוּלָה. שֶׁאָדָם רוֹצֶה לִקְנוֹת שִׁפְחָה בְּתוּלָה לִתְּנָהּ לְעַבְדּוֹ שֶׁהוּא רוֹצֶה בַּהֲנָיָתוֹ וְטוֹבָתוֹ. וְרוֹאִין כַּמָּה פָּחֲתָה וְיִשַּׁלֵּם צַעַר לְפִי קַטְנוּתָהּ וּבְנִין גּוּפָהּ. וּלְפִי שָׁנָיו וְגוּפוֹ אוֹמְדִין כַּמָּה הָאָב רוֹצֶה לִתֵּן וְלֹא תִּצְטַעֵר זוֹ מִזֶּה וְיִתֵּן:

Damages [are evaluated] according to [the girl's] beauty. We look at her as if she were a maid-servant being sold in the marketplace: what price would she fetch as a virgin, and what price would she fetch as a non-virgin. For a man would like to buy a virgin maid-servant to give him to his servant, whose welfare and satisfaction he desires. [The rapist or the seducer] should pay the difference in the price. The compensation for pain is evaluated based on her youth and the size of her body, and his age and the size of his body. We evaluate how much a father would be willing to pay so that such [a daughter] would not suffer pain from such [a man], and [the rapist is obligated to] pay [this amount].

Halachah 7

הַמְפַתֶּה נוֹתֵן בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם מִיָּד וְאֵינוֹ נוֹתֵן הַקְּנָס אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן לֹא נְשָׂאָהּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שמות כב טז) "וְאִם מָאֵן יְמָאֵן אָבִיהָ לְתִתָּהּ לוֹ כֶּסֶף יִשְׁקֹל". אֲבָל הָאוֹנֵס נוֹתֵן אַרְבָּעָה דְּבָרִים מִיָּד וְכוֹנֵס. לְפִיכָךְ כְּשֶׁתִּרְצֶה לְהִתְגָּרֵשׁ אוֹ תִּתְאַלְמֵן אֵין לָהּ כְּלוּם:

A seducer must compensate [the girl's father] for the embarrassment and damages immediately. He is not, however, required to pay the fine unless he does not marry [the girl], as [Exodus 22:16] states: "If her father refuses to allow him to marry her, then he must pay...." A rapist, by contrast, must make all four payments and marry her immediately. Therefore, whenever the woman desires to divorce or when she becomes widowed, she does not receive anything.

Halachah 8

בָּאוּ עָלֶיהָ שְׁנַיִם אֶחָד כְּדַרְכָּהּ וְאֶחָד שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ זֶה שֶׁבָּא עָלֶיהָ שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ אִם הוּא רִאשׁוֹן חַיָּב בְּבֹשֶׁת וּפְגָם וְאִם הוּא אַחֲרוֹן חַיָּב בְּבֹשֶׁת בִּלְבַד שֶׁכְּבָר נִפְגְּמָה. וְזֶה שֶׁבָּא עָלֶיהָ כְּדַרְכָּהּ בֵּין רִאשׁוֹן בֵּין אַחֲרוֹן חַיָּב בְּקִנְסָ וּבִשְׁאָר הַדְּבָרִים. אֲבָל אֵין בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם שֶׁל בַּת שֶׁלֹּא נִבְעֲלָה כְּלָל כְּבֹשֶׁת וּפְגָם זוֹ שֶׁנִּבְעֲלָה שֶׁלֹּא כְּדַרְכָּהּ:

[The following laws apply when] two men entered into relations with her, one through vaginal intercourse and one through anal intercourse. If the man who had anal intercourse with her was first, he is liable for embarrassment and for damages. If he was second, he is

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

liable only for embarrassment, because she has already suffered damages. The one who engaged in vaginal intercourse, whether first or last, is liable for the fine and all other payments. Nevertheless, the embarrassment and damages to a girl who had never engaged in relations at all cannot be compared to the embarrassment and damages to a girl who has engaged in anal intercourse.

Halachah 9

כְּבָר הוֹדַעְנוּ הַבָּנוֹת שֶׁאֵין לָהֶן קְנָס וְעֶשֶׂר הֵן. הַבּוֹגֶרֶת. וְהַמְמָאֶנֶת. וְהַמְגֹרֶשֶׁת. וְהָאֵילוֹנִית. וְהַשּׁוֹטָה. וְהַחֵרֶשֶׁת. וְהַגִּיֹּרֶת. וְהַשְּׁבוּיָה. וְהַמְשֻׁחְרֶרֶת. וְהַיּוֹצֵא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע. וּשְׁאָר הַבָּנוֹת יֵשׁ לָהֶן קְנָס:

We have already mentioned the girls for whom a fine need not be paid: They are ten: A bogeret, a girl who dissolved her marriage via mi'un, one who was divorced, an aylonit, a mentally incompetent girl, a deaf mute, a convert, a girl who had been taken captive, a freed slave, and one who has a tarnished reputation. A fine must be paid for all other girls.

Halachah 10

כָּל בַּת שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ קְנָס יֵשׁ לָהּ בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם. וְאִם הָיְתָה אֲנוּסָה יֵשׁ לָהּ צַעַר. וְכָל בַּת שֶׁאֵין לָהּ קְנָס כָּךְ אֵין לָהּ לֹא בּשֶׁת וְלֹא פְּגָם אִם נִתְפַּתְּתָה וְכֵן אִם נֶאֱנְסָה חוּץ מִבּוֹגֶרֶת וּמְמָאֶנֶת וְשׁוֹטָה וְחֵרֶשֶׁת:

Whenever a fine is required to be paid for a girl, compensation is also required for embarrassment and damages, and if she was raped she must also be compensated for the pain. Conversely, whenever a fine is not required to be paid for her, she is not entitled to compensation for embarrassment and damages if she is seduced or raped. Exceptions to this are a bogeret, a girl who had dissolved her marriage via mi'un, a mentally incompetent girl and a deaf mute. [If they are seduced, no payment is required at all.]

Halachah 11

כֵּיצַד. הָאוֹנֵס אֶת הַבּוֹגֶרֶת וְאֶת הַמְמָאֶנֶת אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵין לָהֶן קְנָס יֵשׁ לָהֶן בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם וְצַעַר. וְהָאוֹנֵס שׁוֹטָה אוֹ חֵרֶשֶׁת מְשַׁלֵּם צַעַר בִּלְבַד. אֲבָל הַמְפַתֶּה אֶת כֻּלָּן פָּטוּר מִכְּלוּם:

What is implied? If a man rapes a bogeret or a girl who had dissolved her marriage via mi'un, although a fine is not required to be paid, compensation is also required for embarrassment damages and pain. And a man who rapes a mentally incompetent girl or a deaf mute is required to make compensation for pain. One who seduces any of these girls is not liable at all.

Halachah 12

אֵין אָדָם מְשַׁלֵּם קְנָס בְּכָל מָקוֹם בְּהוֹדָאַת פִּיו אֶלָּא עַל פִּי עֵדִים. לְפִיכָךְ הָאוֹמֵר אָנַסְתִּי אוֹ פִתִּיתִי בְּתוֹ שֶׁל פְּלוֹנִי אֵינוֹ מְשַׁלֵּם קְנָס אֲבָל מְשַׁלֵּם בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם בְּהוֹדָאַת פִּיו. וְכֵן בַּת שֶׁתָּבְעָה אִישׁ בַּדִּין וְאָמְרָה לוֹ אָנַסְתָּ אוֹ פִתִּיתָ אוֹתִי וְהוּא אוֹמֵר לֹא הָיוּ דְּבָרִים מֵעוֹלָם הֲרֵי זֶה נִשְׁבָּע שְׁבוּעַת הֵסֶת שֶׁאִלּוּ

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

הוֹדָה הָיָה מְשַׁלֵּם לָהּ בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם וְצַעַר עַל פִּי עַצְמוֹ:

A person is not ever liable to pay a fine because of his own admission. Instead, he is made liable by the testimony of witnesses. Therefore, [if a man] says: "I raped or seduced the daughter of so and so," he is not liable to pay a fine. He must, however, make restitution for the embarrassment and the damages [he caused]. Similarly, when a maiden files a legal claim against a man, saying "You raped me," or "You seduced me," and he denies the matter entirely, he is required to take a Rabbinic oath to support his claim, for if he admits his culpability, he would be liable for the embarrassment, the damages and the pain.

Halachah 13

אָמְרָה לוֹ אָנַסְתָּ אוֹתִי וְהוּא אוֹמֵר לֹא כִּי אֶלָּא פִּתִּיתִי הֲרֵי זֶה נִשְׁבָּע שְׁבוּעַת הַתּוֹרָה עַל דְּמֵי הַצַּעַר וּמְשַׁלֵּם בּשֶׁת וּפְגָם שֶׁהֲרֵי הוֹדָה בְּמִקְצָת הַטַּעֲנָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּתְבָּאֵר בִּמְקוֹמוֹ:

If a girl claims, "You raped me," and the man claims, "No, I seduced you," he is required to take an oath mandated by Scriptural law with regard to [the compensation for] the pain, and he must pay the damages and the embarrassment. [The oath is required] because he admitted a portion of the claim [made against him], as will be explained in [the section dealing with that subject].

Halachah 14

שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים שֶׁל מְפַתֶּה וְאַרְבָּעָה שֶׁל אוֹנֵס הֲרֵי הֵן שֶׁל אָב שֶׁכָּל שֶׁבַח נְעוּרִים לוֹ. וְאִם אֵין לָהּ אָב הֲרֵי הֵן שֶׁל עַצְמָהּ:

The three payments made because of seduction, and the four payments made because of rape are made to the girl's father, for all the monetary benefit that accrues during a girl's youth belongs to her father. If her father is no longer alive [at the time of the rape or the seduction], [these payments are made] to her.

Halachah 15

מְפֻתָּה אוֹ אֲנוּסָה שֶׁלֹּא תָּבְעָה עַד שֶׁבָּגְרָה אוֹ עַד שֶׁנִּשֵּׂאת אוֹ עַד שֶׁמֵּת הָאָב הָאַרְבָּעָה דְּבָרִים אוֹ הַשְּׁלֹשָׁה שֶׁלָּהּ. עָמְדָה בַּדִּין וְתָבְעָה אוֹתוֹ וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּגְרָה אוֹ שֶׁנִּשֵּׂאת הֲרֵי הֵן שֶׁל אָב. וְאִם מֵת הָאָב אַחַר עֲמִידָתָהּ בַּדִּין הֲרֵי הֵן שֶׁל אַחִין שֶׁהֵן יוֹרְשֵׁי הָאָב. שֶׁמֵּעֵת שֶׁעָמְדָה בְּדִין זָכָה בָּהֶן הָאָב:

When a girl who was raped or seduced does not file a claim until [either] she reaches bagrut, she marries, or her father dies, she herself is entitled to the three or four payments [mentioned above]. If she appeared in court and filed a claim for payment, and then she reached bagrut or she married, the father is entitled to the payments. If the father dies after she files a claim for payment in court, the payments belong to her brothers, for they are her father's heirs. [The rationale is that] once she files a claim for payment in court, her father is considered to have acquired the payments.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

Halachah 16

הַבַּת שֶׁנִּתְאָרְסָה וְנִתְגָּרְשָׁה קְנָסָהּ לְבַדּוֹ לְעַצְמָהּ. נֶאֱנְסָה אוֹ נִתְפַּתְּתָה וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִתְקַדְּשָׁה לְאַחֵר קְנָסָהּ וּשְׁאָר הַדְּבָרִים לְאָבִיהָ. שֶׁאֵין הָאֵרוּסִין מוֹצִיאִין מֵרְשׁוּת אָב:

When a girl was consecrated and then divorced, she is entitled to the fine, but only that. If she was raped or seduced, and afterwards, she becomes consecrated to another [man], her father is entitled to the fine and the damages, for consecration does not take a girl out of her father's domain [and nullify his rights over her].

Halachah 17

אֲנִי אוֹמֵר שֶׁזֶּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּתּוֹרָה (ויקרא יט כט) "אַל תְּחַלֵּל אֶת בִּתְּךָ לְהַזְנוֹתָהּ". שֶׁלֹּא יֹאמַר הָאָב הוֹאִיל וְלֹא חִיְּבָה תּוֹרָה מְפַתֶּה וְאוֹנֵס אֶלָּא שֶׁיִּתֵּן מָמוֹן לָאָב הֲרֵינִי שׂוֹכֵר בִּתִּי הַבְּתוּלָה לָזֶה לָבוֹא עָלֶיהָ בְּכָל מָמוֹן שֶׁאֶרְצֶה אוֹ אֲנִיחַ זֶה לָבוֹא עָלֶיהָ בְּחִנָּם שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ לָאָדָם לִמְחל מָמוֹנוֹ לְכָל מִי שֶׁיִּרְצֶה לְכָךְ נֶאֱמַר אַל תְּחַלֵּל אֶת בִּתְּךָ. שֶׁזֶּה שֶׁחִיְּבָה תּוֹרָה לָאוֹנֵס וְלַמְפַתֶּה מָמוֹן וְלֹא מַלְקוּת בְּשֶׁאֵרַע הַדָּבָר מִקְרֶה שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת אָבִיהָ וְלֹא הֻכִינָה עַצְמָהּ לְכָךְ שֶׁדָּבָר זֶה אֵינוֹ הַוֶּה תָּמִיד וְאֵינוֹ מָצוּי. אֲבָל אִם הֻנִּיחַ בִּתּוֹ בְּתוּלָה מוּכָנֶת לְכָל מִי שֶׁיָּבוֹא עָלֶיהָ גּוֹרֵם שֶׁתִּתְמַלֵּא הָאָרֶץ זִמָּה וְנִמְצָא הָאָב נוֹשֵׂא בִּתּוֹ וְהָאָח נוֹשֵׂא אֲחוֹתוֹ שֶׁאִם תִּתְעַבֵּר וְתֵלֵד לֹא יְוַדַּע בֶּן מִי הוּא. וְהַמֵּכִין בִּתּוֹ לְכָךְ הֲרֵי הִיא קְדֵשָׁה וְלוֹקֶה הַבּוֹעֵל וְהַנִּבְעֶלֶת מִשּׁוּם (דברים כג יח) "לֹא תִהְיֶה קְדֵשָׁה". וְאֵין קוֹנְסִין אוֹתוֹ שֶׁלֹּא חִיְּבָה תּוֹרָה קְנָס אֶלָּא לְאוֹנֵס וּמְפַתֶּה אֲבָל זוֹ שֶׁהֻכִינָה עַצְמָהּ לְכָךְ בֵּין מִדַּעְתָּהּ בֵּין מִדַּעַת אָבִיהָ הֲרֵי זוֹ קְדֵשָׁה. וְאִסּוּר קְדֵשָׁה אֶחָד הוּא בֵּין בִּבְתוּלָה בֵּין בִּבְעוּלָה לְפִיכָךְ אָמְרוּ חֲכָמִים שֶׁהַיּוֹצֵא עָלֶיהָ שֵׁם רַע בְּיַלְדוּתָהּ אֵין לָהּ קְנָס כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֵּאַרְנוּ שֶׁהֲרֵי זוֹ בְּחֶזְקַת שֶׁהִפְקִירָה עַצְמָהּ לְדָבָר זֶה בִּרְצוֹנָהּ:

I maintain that [the intent of] the Torah's statement [Leviticus 19:29], "Do not defile your daughter to have her play the harlot," is that a father should not say: "Since the obligation of the Torah for a seducer or a rapist was solely that he should give the father money, I will hire my virgin daughter to someone to have relations with her for whatever price I desire, or I will allow him to have relations for her without charge. For a man has the right to forgo monetary rights to him to any person he desires." To counter such thoughts, it is written: "Do not defile your daughter." The Torah obligates a rapist and a seducer to pay money rather than be punished by lashes when the matter happened by chance, without the knowledge of [the girl's] father, and she did not ready herself for [the relations]. For this is an extraordinary and uncommon matter. If, however, a person leaves his virgin daughter accessible for anyone to engage in relations with her, this will cause the entire earth to be filled with sexual immorality. For [ultimately], a father will marry his daughter and a brother his sister, [for in a sexually permissive society] a [girl] may become pregnant and give birth without knowing who the child's father is. When a person has his daughter act in this manner, she is considered to be a harlot, and both the man and the girl who engage in

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

relations should be punished by lashes, as [Deuteronomy 23:18] states: "There shall not be a harlot." [In such an instance,] the man is not required to pay a fine, for the Torah prescribed a fine only in the instance of seduction or rape. When a girl prepares herself [for relations] either on her initiative or on that of her father, she is a harlot. And the prohibition against harlotry applies both with regard to a virgin and a non-virgin. For this reason our Sages stated that a girl who was reputed to have conducted herself immodestly while young is not entitled to a fine, as we have explained, for we can assume that she willingly opened herself to this experience.

Commentary

The chapter is a price list, and the Rambam builds it with accountant's patience. Halachot 1-6 lay out the tariff: the kenas is a fixed fifty silver, identical for all — "whether one comes upon the daughter of the High Priest or the daughter of a convert or a mamzer" — while boshet (shame) is assessed by the standing of both parties, pegam (diminution) by the girl's depreciation like a slave-girl's market value, and tza'ar (pain) only for the rapist, since the seduced girl suffers none. The seducer pays three; the rapist, four.

Halachot 7-11 handle the edge cases — two offenders in sequence, the ten categories of girls with no kenas — and 12-13 the procedure: no fine is ever paid on self-admission (only witnesses obligate), while shame and damages are. Then 14-17 answer the money's destination: the father, for "all the profit of youth is his" — unless she did not claim until majority, marriage, or her father's death, when the payments become hers.

The commentators show their methods. Kessef Mishneh is the source-tracer: halachah 1's "fifty silver is only the price of the pleasure of lying" comes from Ketubot 39a-40a, Rava's reading of Deuteronomy 22:29 — the verse prices the act, implying shame and diminution are additional; the rapist's pain-payment from the same mishnah. Migdal Oz names the Talmudic addresses in one line: the whole chapter sits in Arakhin's Yesh Be'erkhin and Ketubot's Elu Ne'arot.

Ohr Sameach is the conceptual analyst. On halachah 15 he notes the Rambam follows Tosafot that boshet and pegam travel with the kenas — but diverges on the mechanism: Tosafot hold that wherever the kenas is hers, the others are too; the Rambam holds only the kenas is hers, and only by divine decree (gezerat hakatuv). His proof is the betrothed-and-divorced na'arah, whose shame-payment stays the father's per the Yerushalmi — because those payments are 'profit of youth,' not decree.

The gem is the chapter's last line, in the Rambam's own voice: "אני אומר" — I maintain. Leviticus 19:29, "do not profane your daughter," means a father may not reason that since the Torah only obliges the seducer or rapist to pay the father money, he may rent out his virgin daughter to the highest bidder. The chapter's tariff is not a price list for purchase; it

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

closes, in its final breath, the very loophole its economics might open.

Commentaries: Kessef Mishneh and Migdal Oz via Sefaria's linked commentary; Ohr Sameach on 2:15. No Maggid Mishneh on this chapter in Sefaria — omitted, not reconstructed.

GOV.IL ·

The government on this week's learning

One document this week — and it lands squarely on the daf:

בקשה לקבלת היתר למכירת בכורות בקר או צאן

gov.il

A government service page where cattle and sheep farmers apply for a permit to sell firstborn animals (מכירת בכורות) — the modern administrative form of the very institution Bekhorot governs. The main sale takes place on erev Pesach, with further sales at the start of each month. The daf's thirty/fifty-day tending rules and the expert's blemish inspection are the halachic ancestors of this permit process.

https://www.gov.il/he/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep

NLI ·

Bekhorot on stage

The National Library's archive holds a 2006 poster from the Rina Schenfeld Dance Theatre: 'בכורות 2006' — Bekhorot 2006 — an evening of two new dance works ("הילדה הכי יפה בגן" and "מוספורי גן עדן"). Three thousand years after the tractate, the word for 'firstborns' does new work in Modern Hebrew: premieres, first-born creations. The poster's license could not be verified through the Library's viewer from this machine, so it is cited rather than reproduced — a prose postcard from the archive instead of an image.

כרזה - 'בכורות 2006' · 2006

https://www.nli.org.il/en/archives/NNL_ARCHIVE_AL997008796613005171

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 4

Genesis 8:15-9:7

15 verses

The fourth aliyah of Noach: Noah, his family, and every living thing leave the ark; Noah builds an altar and offers from every clean animal and bird; God vows never again to curse the ground for man's sake; the seasons are fixed; humankind is blessed, given the animals for food, and warned — your blood will be required, for in the image of אלקים He made man. Read each Hebrew verse twice, the Targum once: the ancient discipline of shnayim mikra ve-echad targum.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

אלקים

Genesis 8:15 · ×2

וַיְדַבֵּר אֱלֹקִים אֶל־נֹחַ לֵאמֹר׃
וַיְדַבֵּר אֱלֹקִים אֶל־נֹחַ לֵאמֹר׃
ומַלֵּיל יְיָ עִם נֹחַ לְמֵימָר׃

Genesis 8:16 · ×2

צֵא מִן־הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּבָנֶיךָ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ׃
צֵא מִן־הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּבָנֶיךָ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ׃
פּוֹק מִן תֵּבוּתָא אַתְּ וְאִתְּתָךְ וּבְנָךְ וּנְשֵׁי בְנָךְ עִמָּךְ׃

עלהארץ
ארעא

Genesis 8:17 · ×2

כָּל־הַחַיָּה אֲשֶׁר־אִתְּךָ מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּעוֹף וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ
עַל־הָאָרֶץ (הוצא) [הַיְצֵא] אִתָּךְ וְשָׁרְצוּ בָאָרֶץ וּפָרוּ וְרָבוּ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
כָּל־הַחַיָּה אֲשֶׁר־אִתְּךָ מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּעוֹף וּבַבְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ
עַל־הָאָרֶץ (הוצא) [הַיְצֵא] אִתָּךְ וְשָׁרְצוּ בָאָרֶץ וּפָרוּ וְרָבוּ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
כָּל חַיְתָא דְּעִמָּךְ מִכָּל בִּשְׂרָא בְּעוֹפָא וּבִבְעִירָא וּבְכָל רְחֲשָׁא דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא
אַפֵּיק עִמָּךְ וְיִתְיַלְּדוּן בְּאַרְעָא וְיִפְּשׁוּן וְיִסְגּוּן עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 8:18 · ×2

וַיֵּצֵא־נֹחַ וּבָנָיו וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתּוֹ׃
וַיֵּצֵא־נֹחַ וּבָנָיו וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתּוֹ׃
וּנְפַק נֹחַ וּבְנוֹהִי וְאִתְּתֵיהּ וּנְשֵׁי בְנוֹהִי עִמֵּיהּ׃

Genesis 8:19 · ×2

כָּל־הַחַיָּה כָּל־הָרֶמֶשׂ וְכָל־הָעוֹף כֹּל רוֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתֵיהֶם יָצְאוּ מִן־הַתֵּבָה׃
כָּל־הַחַיָּה כָּל־הָרֶמֶשׂ וְכָל־הָעוֹף כֹּל רוֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתֵיהֶם יָצְאוּ מִן־הַתֵּבָה׃
כָּל חַיְתָא כָּל רְחֲשָׁא וְכָל עוֹפָא כֹּל דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא לְזַרְעַיְתְהוֹן נְפָקוּ מִן תֵּבוּתָא׃

Genesis 8:20 · ×2

וַיִּבֶן נֹחַ מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה וַיִּקַּח מִכֹּל | הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהֹרָה וּמִכֹּל הָעוֹף הַטָּהוֹר וַיַּעַל עֹלֹת בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ׃
וַיִּבֶן נֹחַ מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה וַיִּקַּח מִכֹּל | הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהֹרָה וּמִכֹּל הָעוֹף הַטָּהוֹר וַיַּעַל עֹלֹת בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ׃
וּבְנָא נֹחַ מַדְבְּחָא קֳדָם יְיָ וּנְסִיב מִכֹּל בְּעִירָא דַכְיָא וּמִכֹּל עוֹפָא דְכֵי וְאַסֵּיק עֲלָוָן בְּמַדְבְּחָא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

האדם
דאנשא

Genesis 8:21 · ×2

וַיָּרַח יְהוָה אֶת־רֵיחַ הַנִּיחֹחַ וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־לִבּוֹ לֹא־אֹסִף לְקַלֵּל עוֹד
אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה בַּעֲבוּר הָאָדָם כִּי יֵצֶר לֵב הָאָדָם רַע מִנְּעֻרָיו וְלֹא־אֹסִף עוֹד
לְהַכּוֹת אֶת־כָּל־חַי כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי:
וַיָּרַח יְהוָה אֶת־רֵיחַ הַנִּיחֹחַ וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־לִבּוֹ לֹא־אֹסִף לְקַלֵּל עוֹד
אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה בַּעֲבוּר הָאָדָם כִּי יֵצֶר לֵב הָאָדָם רַע מִנְּעֻרָיו וְלֹא־אֹסִף עוֹד
לְהַכּוֹת אֶת־כָּל־חַי כַּאֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי:
וְקַבִּיל יְיָ בְּרַעֲוָא יָת קוּרְבָּנֵיהּ וַאֲמַר יְיָ בְּמֵימְרֵיהּ לָא אוֹסִף לְמֵילַט עוֹד יָת
אַרְעָא בְּדִיל חוֹבֵי אֱנָשָׁא אֲרֵי יְצַרָא לִבָּא דֶּאֱנָשָׁא בִּישׁ מִזְּעֵירֵיהּ וְלָא אוֹסִף עוֹד
לְמִמְחֵי יָת כָּל דְּחַי כְּמָא דְּעֲבָדִית:

Genesis 8:22 · ×2

עֹד כָּל־יְמֵי הָאָרֶץ זֶרַע וְקָצִיר וְקֹר וָחֹם וְקַיִץ וָחֹרֶף וְיוֹם וָלָיְלָה לֹא יִשְׁבֹּתוּ:
עֹד כָּל־יְמֵי הָאָרֶץ זֶרַע וְקָצִיר וְקֹר וָחֹם וְקַיִץ וָחֹרֶף וְיוֹם וָלָיְלָה לֹא יִשְׁבֹּתוּ:
עוֹד כָּל יוֹמֵי אַרְעָא זַרְעָא וַחֲצָדָא וְקוּרָא וְחוֹמָא וְקַיְטָא וְסִתְוָא וְיוֹמָם וְלֵילְיָא לָא יִבְטְלוּן:

Genesis 9:1 · ×2

וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ וְאֶת־בָּנָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמִלְאוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ:
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ וְאֶת־בָּנָיו וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ וּמִלְאוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ:
וּבָרִיךְ יְיָ יָת נֹחַ וְיָת בְּנוֹהִי וַאֲמַר לְהוֹן פּוּשׁוּ וְסִגוּ וּמְלוּ יָת אַרְעָא:

Genesis 9:2 · ×2

וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם וְחִתְּכֶם יִהְיֶה עַל כָּל־חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ וְעַל כָּל־עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר תִּרְמֹשׂ הָאֲדָמָה וּבְכָל־דְּגֵי
הַיָּם בְּיֶדְכֶם נִתָּנוּ:
וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם וְחִתְּכֶם יִהְיֶה עַל כָּל־חַיַּת הָאָרֶץ וְעַל כָּל־עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר תִּרְמֹשׂ הָאֲדָמָה וּבְכָל־דְּגֵי
הַיָּם בְּיֶדְכֶם נִתָּנוּ:
וְדַחֲלַתְכוֹן וְאֵימַתְכוֹן תְּהֵי עַל כָּל חֵוַת אַרְעָא וְעַל כָּל עוֹפָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא בְּכֹל דִּי תַרְחֵישׁ אַרְעָא וּבְכָל נוּנֵי יַמָּא בִּיְדֵכוֹן
יְהוֹן מְסִירִין:

Genesis 9:3 · ×2

כָּל־רֶמֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר הוּא־חַי לָכֶם יִהְיֶה לְאָכְלָה כְּיֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת־כֹּל:
כָּל־רֶמֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר הוּא־חַי לָכֶם יִהְיֶה לְאָכְלָה כְּיֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת־כֹּל:
כָּל רִחֲשָׁא דְּהוּא חַי לְכוֹן יְהֵי לְמֵיכַל כִּירוֹק עִשְׂבָּא יְהַבִית לְכוֹן יָת כֹּלָּא:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

Genesis 9:4 · ×2

אַךְ־בָּשָׂר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ דָמוֹ לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ׃
אַךְ־בָּשָׂר בְּנַפְשׁוֹ דָמוֹ לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ׃
בְּרַם בִּשְׂרָא בְּנַפְשֵׁיהּ דְּמֵיהּ לָא תֵכְלוּן׃

Genesis 9:5 · ×2

וְאַךְ אֶת־דִּמְכֶם לְנַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶם אֶדְרֹשׁ מִיַּד כָּל־חַיָּה אֶדְרְשֶׁנּוּ וּמִיַּד הָאָדָם מִיַּד׀ אִישׁ אָחִיו אֶדְרֹשׁ אֶת־נֶפֶשׁ הָאָדָם׃
וְאַךְ אֶת־דִּמְכֶם לְנַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶם אֶדְרֹשׁ מִיַּד כָּל־חַיָּה אֶדְרְשֶׁנּוּ וּמִיַּד הָאָדָם מִיַּד׀ אִישׁ אָחִיו אֶדְרֹשׁ אֶת־נֶפֶשׁ הָאָדָם׃
וּבְרַם יָת דִּמְכוֹן לְנַפְשָׁתֵיכוֹן אֶתְבַּע מִיַּד כָּל חַיְתָא אֶתְבְּעִנֵּיהּ וּמִיַּד אֱנָשָׁא מִיַּד גְּבַר דְּיֵשׁוּד יָת דְּמָא דַּאֲחוֹהִי אֶתְבַּע יָת נַפְשָׁא דֶּאֱנָשָׁא׃

Genesis 9:6 · ×2

שֹׁפֵךְ׀ דַּם הָאָדָם בָּאָדָם דָּמוֹ יִשָּׁפֵךְ כִּי בְצֶלֶם אֱלֹקִים עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם׃
שֹׁפֵךְ׀ דַּם הָאָדָם בָּאָדָם דָּמוֹ יִשָּׁפֵךְ כִּי בְצֶלֶם אֱלֹקִים עָשָׂה אֶת־הָאָדָם׃
דְּיֵשׁוֹד דְּמָא דֶּאֱנָשָׁא בְּסַהֲדִין עַל מֵימַר דַּיְנַיָּא דְּמֵיהּ יִתְשַׁד אֲרֵי בְּצַלְמָא דַּיְיָ עֲבַד יָת אֱנָשָׁא׃

Genesis 9:7 · ×2

וְאַתֶּם פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ שִׁרְצוּ בָאָרֶץ וּרְבוּ־בָהּ׃
וְאַתֶּם פְּרוּ וּרְבוּ שִׁרְצוּ בָאָרֶץ וּרְבוּ־בָהּ׃
וְאַתּוּן פּוּשׁוּ וּסְגוּ אִתְיְלִידוּ בְּאַרְעָא וּסְגוּ בַהּ׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 9:6

"באדם" means "by means of a man" — the bet is instrumental, an ablative as in other languages. And "for in the image of אלקים He made man" grants dignity to man of every nation: murder of a non-Jew is forbidden by the Torah itself, since tzelem Elohim is universal, not Israel's private property.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 8:21

"וירח" is parsed on the pattern of "וינח" (Exodus 10:14), the resh opened before the guttural chet — and "חלילה חלילה להיות השם מריח," God forbid that God smells: rather the offering was accepted, pleasing to Him "like a man smelling a good scent."

Em LaMikra · Gen 8:21

Pushes back on Shadal's historical argument: the prophets had to labor to uproot the people's attachment to sacrifices — which proves the people of the prophets' era esteemed

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

sacrifices MORE than Moses' generation did. What changed was the teachers' assumptions (Luzzatto's), not the people's.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 8:21

"וירח ה'" — God was appeased; the essence of sacrifice per peshat is the offerer's will and desire: the offerer symbolically offers himself, all his soul's powers, to ascend the spiritual altar as the offering ascends the earthly one (citing Zohar Pinchas).

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 9:2

חתת is greater than מורא: חתת is sudden terror when danger is near, מורא is worry when danger is far. Hence the verse distributes מוראכם to the birds and חתכם to the beasts — Hebrew's habit of completing with what it opened ("משפט הלשון להחל במה שהשלים").

Netinah LaGer · Gen 8:21

"מנעוריו" — from his SMALLNESS (מזעיריה), not his greatness: because the evil inclination begins to rule in the heart from childhood.

Onkelos: translation notes

Gen 8:15

ומליל יי עם נח וידבר אלקים אלנח

"Spoke to Noah" becomes "spoke WITH Noah" — Onkelos prefers עם over אל for divine speech, turning address into conversation; and אלקים is rendered יי throughout, his fixed divine-name convention.

Gen 8:20

ובנא נח מדבחא קדם יי ויבן נח מזבח ליהוה

The altar is built not "to the Lord" but "before the Lord" — the קדם periphrasis, Onkelos's signature anti-anthropomorphism, keeping God out of spatial contact with the stones.

Gen 8:21

וקביל יי ברעוא ית קורבניה וירח יהוה אתריח הניחח

God "smelling" is unthinkable in the Targum: it becomes "the Lord accepted his offering with favor" (רעוא). Smell is replaced by will — the offering pleases because it is willed, not because it is sniffed.

Gen 8:21

ואמר יי במימריה ויאמר יהוה אללבו

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

"To His heart" becomes "by His Memra" — the famous Memra doctrine. Divine interiority, a heart that deliberates, is translated into the divine Word; anthropopathic psychology becomes theology.

Gen 8:21

מזעיריה ... בדיל חובי אנשא מנעוריו ... בעבור האדם

"Because of man" is glossed "because of the sins of man" — a theological correction: the ground was cursed on account of human sin, not of man as such. And מנעוריו (from his youth) becomes מזעיריה, from his smallness — childhood, not youth.

Gen 8:19

לזרעיתהון למשפחתיהם

"By their families" becomes "by their kinds" (זרע) — a midrashic reading: the ark's passengers disembark species by species, each seed with its seed.

Gen 9:5

מיד גבר דישוד ית דמא דאחוהי מיד איש אחיו

"From each man's brother" is expanded into "from a man who sheds his brother's blood" — the Targum explicates the verse's own logic inside the translation, naming the crime the Hebrew leaves implied.

Gen 9:6

דישוד דמא דאנשא בסהדין על מימר דיניא דמיה יתשד שפך דם האדם באדם דמו ישפך

"By man shall his blood be shed" becomes "by witnesses, by verdict of judges, shall his blood be shed" — the Sanhedrin 57b reading: capital justice runs through courts, never through private hands.

RASHI

Rashi on the day's aliyah

28 comments

Every one of Rashi's 28 comments on Genesis 8:15-9:7, in his Hebrew with English — the ark emptied, the altar built, the vow, the covenant of the seasons, and the first laws given to humankind after the flood.

אתה ואשתך וגו'.

אִישׁ וְאִשְׁתּוֹ, כָּאן הִתִּיר לָהֶם תַּשְׁמִישׁ הַמִּטָּה:

אתה ואשתך וגו' *THOU AND THY WIFE etc. — Husband and wife are mentioned together— now He allowed them to resume family life (Genesis Rabbah 34:8).*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

הוצא.

הוֹצֵא כְּתִיב, הֵיצֵא קְרִי, הֵיצֵא אֱמֹר לָהֶם שֶׁיֵּצְאוּ; הוֹצֵא אִם אֵינָם רוֹצִים לָצֵאת הוֹצִיאֵם אַתָּה:

הוצא *BRING FORTH — The Ketib is* הוצא *and the Keri* היצא*;* היצא *means, "tell them to go forth",* הוצא *means, "if they do not wish (if they refuse) to go forth, you make them go out".*

ושרצו בארץ.

וְלֹא בַּתֵּבָה, מַגִּיד שֶׁאַף הַבְּהֵמָה וְהָעוֹף נֶאֶסְרוּ בְתַשְׁמִישׁ:

ושרצו בארץ *THAT THEY MAY BRING FORTH ABUNDANTLY IN THE EARTH but not in the Ark:*

this teaches that cattle and fowls also were separated, male and female, in the Ark (Genesis Rabbah 34:8).

למשפחותיהם.

קִבְּלוּ עֲלֵיהֶם עַל מְנָת לְדַבֵּק בְּמִינָן:

למשפחתיהם *AFTER THEIR FAMILIES — They took upon themselves to keep to their specie.*

מכל הבהמה הטהורה.

אָמַר לֹא צִוָּה לִי הַקָּבָ"ה לְהַכְנִיס מֵאֵלּוּ ז' ז' אֶלָּא כְּדֵי לְהַקְרִיב קָרְבָּן מֵהֶם:

מכל הבהמה הטהרה *OF ALL CLEAN CATTLE — He said: "The Holy One, blessed be He, ordered me to take in seven pairs of these only in order that I might offer a sacrifice of them" (Genesis Rabbah 34:9).*

מנעריו.

מנעריו כְּתִיב, מִשֶּׁנִּנְעַר לָצֵאת מִמְּעֵי אִמּוֹ נִתַּן בּוֹ יֵצֶר הָרָע:

מנעריו *FROM HIS YOUTH — This word is written without a Vav after the* ע *so that it may be read as* מנעריו *which would imply that from the moment the embryo bestirs itself to have an independent existence the evil inclination is given to it (Genesis Rabbah 34:10).*

לא אסף ולא אסף.

כְּפַל הַדָּבָר לִשְׁבוּעָה; הוּא שֶׁכָּתוּב אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי מֵעָבֹר מֵי נֹחַ, וְלֹא מָצִינוּ בָּהּ שְׁבוּעָה,

ולא אסף...לא אסף *I WILL NEVER AGAIN ... NEITHER WILL I EVER AGAIN — He repeated the expression that it might serve as a solemn oath, and it is to this that the text (Isaiah 54:9) refers: "For as I have sworn that the waters of Noah [will never again pass over the earth]".*

אֶלָּא זוֹ שֶׁכְּפַל דְּבָרָיו וְהִיא שְׁבוּעָה וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ חֲכָמִים בְּמס' שְׁבוּעוֹת:

We, however, do not find any explicit oath regarding this, but this passage in which He repeated these words, which may be regarded as an oath.

Thus do our Sages explain in Treatise Shevuot 36a.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

עוד כל ימי הארץ וגו' לא ישבתו.

ו' עִתִּים הַלָּלוּ שְׁנֵי חֳדָשִׁים לְכָל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד,

לא ישבתו ׳עוד כל ימי הארץ וגו *WHILE THE EARTH REMAINETH ... SHALL NOT CEASE — Of these six seasons each consists of two months, as we have learned (Bava Metzia 106b):*

כְּמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁנִינוּ חֲצִי תִשְׁרֵי וּמַרְחֶשְׁוָן וַחֲצִי כִסְלֵו זֶרַע,

Half of Tishri, Marcheshvan and half of Kislev is seedtime;

חֲצִי כִסְלֵו וְטֵבֵת וַחֲצִי שְׁבָט קֹר (חֹרֶף) (ב"מ ק"ו):

half of Kislev, Tebeth and half of Shebat is the cold-season.

קור.

קָשֶׁה מֵחֹרֶף:

קור *COLD-SEASON is more severe than* חורף *winter.*

חרף.

עֵת זֶרַע שְׂעוֹרִים וְקִטְנִית הַחֲרִיפִין לְהִתְבַּשֵּׁל מַהֵר, וְהוּא חֲצִי שְׁבָט וַאֲדָר וַחֲצִי נִיסָן:

חורף *WINTER is the time of sowing barley and pulse which are quick (*חריף*) to ripen.*

It is half of Shebat, Adar and half of Nisan.

קציר.

חֲצִי נִיסָן וְאִיָּר וַחֲצִי סִיוָן:

קציר *HARVEST — Half of Nisan, Eyar, and half of Sivan.*

קיץ.

חֲצִי סִיוָן תַּמּוּז וַחֲצִי אָב, הוּא זְמַן לְקִיטַת תְּאֵנִים וּזְמַן שֶׁמְּיַבְּשִׁים אוֹתָן בַּשָּׂדוֹת, וּשְׁמוֹ קַיִץ,

קיץ *SUMMER — Half of Sivan, Tammuz and half of Ab.*

כְּמוֹ הַלֶּחֶם וְהַקַּיִץ לֶאֱכוֹל הַנְּעָרִים (ש"ב ט"ז):

This is the time of fig-gathering, the time when they lay them out to dry in the fields.

and its name is קיץ *“summer-fruittime”, as (2 Samuel 16:2) “And the bread and the summer-fruit (*קיץ*) for the young men to eat”.*

חום.

הוּא סוֹף יְמוֹת הַחַמָּה, חֲצִי אָב וֶאֱלוּל וַחֲצִי תִשְׁרֵי, שֶׁהָעוֹלָם חַם בְּיוֹתֵר;

כְּמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁנִינוּ בְּמַסֶּכֶת יוֹמָא שִׁלְהֵי קַיְיטָא קֶשֵׁי מִקַּיְיטָא:

חום *HEAT — This is the end of the hot season, half of Ab, Elul and half of Tishri, when the world is excessively hot, as we have learned in Treatise Yoma 29a: “The end of the summer is worse than the summer itself”.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

ויום ולילה לא ישבתו.
מִכְּלָל שֶׁשָּׁבְתוּ כָּל יְמוֹת הַמַּבּוּל, שֶׁלֹּא שִׁמְּשׁוּ הַמַּזָּלוֹת,

וְלֹא נִבַּר בֵּין יוֹם וּבֵין לַיְלָה (ב"ר פכ"ה ופ' ל"ד):

וְיוֹם וְלַיְלָה לֹא יִשְׁבֹּתוּ *DAY AND NIGHT SHALL NOT CEASE — From this we may infer that they (day and night) ceased during the period of the Flood, for the planetary system did not function, so that there was no distinction between day and night (Genesis Rabbah 34:11).*

לא ישבתו.
לֹא יִפְסְקוּ כָּל אֵלֶּה מִלְּהִתְנַהֵג כְּסִדְרָן:

לֹא יִשְׁבֹּתוּ *SHALL NOT CEASE — None of these shall cease to take their natural course.*

וחתכם.
וְאֵימַתְכֶם, כְּמוֹ תִּרְאוּ חֻתַּת (איוב ו') וְאַגָּדָה לְשׁוֹן חַיּוּת שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁתִּינוֹק בֶּן יוֹמוֹ חַי אֵין אַתָּה צָרִיךְ לְשָׁמְרוֹ מִן הָעַכְבָּרִים; עוֹג מֶלֶךְ הַבָּשָׁן מֵת, צָרִיךְ לְשָׁמְרוֹ מִן הָעַכְבָּרִים, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּמוֹרַאֲכֶם וְחִתְּכֶם יִהְיֶה, אֵימָתַי יִהְיֶה מוֹרַאֲכֶם עַל הַחַיּוֹת? כָּל זְמַן שֶׁאַתֶּם חַיִּים (שבת קנ"א):

וחתכם *means AND THE DREAD OF YOU, similar to (Job 6:21) "ye see a terror (חתת)." The Agada takes the word as signifying "life", "vitality" (חיות):*

So long as a baby, even one day old, has life you do not have to guard it against the attacks of mice, whilst Og, king of Bashan, when dead needs to be guarded against the attacks of mice, as it is said, "And the fear of you and the terror of you shall be [upon the beasts of the field etc.]." When will the fear of you be upon the beasts?

So long as you are alive (חתכם) (Shabbat 151b).

לכם יהיה לאכלה.
שֶׁלֹּא הִרְשֵׁיתִי לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן בָּשָׂר אֶלָּא יֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב; וְלָכֶם

לכם יהיה לאכלה *SHALL BE FOOD FOR YOU — For I did not permit Adam Harishon to eat meat, but green herbs alone;*

כְּיֶרֶק עֵשֶׂב שֶׁהִפְקַרְתִּי לְאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן, נָתַתִּי לָכֶם אֶת כֹּל (סנה' נ"ט):

but lo you — even as the green herbs that I gave the full use of to Adam Harishon — do I give everything (Sanhedrin 59b).

בשר בנפשו.
אָסַר לָהֶם אֵבֶר מִן הַחַי, כְּלוֹמַר כָּל זְמַן שֶׁנַּפְשׁוֹ בּוֹ, לֹא תֹאכְלוּ הַבָּשָׂר:

בשר בנפשו *FLESH WITH THE SOUL THEREOF [SHALL YE NOT EAT] — He here prohibited to them the eating of a limb cut from a living animal, that is to say that* אבר מן החי *(literally, flesh together with its life) means so long as its life is in it you shall not eat the flesh.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

בנפשו דמו.

בְּעוֹד נַפְשׁוֹ בּוֹ

בנפשו דמו *(literally, its blood together with its life) means whilst its (the animal's) life is still in it (the blood).*

בשר בנפשו לא תאכלו.

הֶרֵי אֵבֶר מִן הַחַי, וְאַף בְּנַפְשׁוֹ דָמוֹ לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ, הֶרֵי דָם מִן הַחַי:

Consequently בשר בנפשו לא תאכלו *FLESH SO LONG AS THERE IS LIFE IN IT SHALL YE NOT EAT forms the prohibition of* אבר מן החי *the eating of a limb cut from a living animal.*

And connecting בנפשו *with* דמו *we obtain the reading also* בנפשו דמו לא תאכלו *ITS BLOOD TOGETHER WITH ITS LIFE SHALL YE NOT EAT which forms the prohibition of partaking of blood of a living animal (Sanhedrin 59a)*

ואך את דמכם.

אַעַ"פִּ שֶׁהִתַּרְתִּי לָכֶם נְטִילַת נְשָׁמָה בַּבְּהֵמָה,

אֶת דְּמְכֶם אֶדְרֹשׁ מֵהַשּׁוֹפֵךְ דַּם עַצְמוֹ:

ואך את דמכם *HOWEVER YOUR BLOOD — Although I have permitted you to take the life of cattle yet your blood I will surely require from him amongst you who sheds his own blood (see Bava Kamma 91b).*

לנפשתיכם.

אַף הַחוֹנֵק עַצְמוֹ, אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁלֹּא יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ דָם:

לנפשותיכם *YOUR LIFE — Even though one strangles himself (Genesis Rabbah 34:13) so that no blood flows from him yet I will require it from him.*

מיד כל חיה.

לְפִי שֶׁחָטְאוּ דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל וְהֻפְקְרוּ לְמַאֲכַל חַיּוֹת רָעוֹת לִשְׁלֹט בָּהֶן,

שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר נִמְשַׁל כַּבְּהֵמוֹת נִדְמוּ (תהלים מ"ט),

לְפִיכָךְ הֻצְרַךְ לְהַזְהִיר עֲלֵיהֶן אֶת הַחַיּוֹת:

מיד כל חיה *AT THE HAND OF EVERY BEAST — Because the generation of the Flood sinned and they were therefore freely exposed to become food for wild beasts which would have power over them — as it is said (Psalms 49:21), "He is ruled over by wild beasts like the beasts that perish" (these being the prey of other animals) (Shabbat 151b) — it was therefore necessary to proclaim a punishment against wild animals on their account.*

ומיד האדם.

מִיַּד הַהוֹרֵג בְּמֵזִיד וְאֵין עֵדִים, אֲנִי אֶדְרֹשׁ:

ומיד האדם *AT THE HAND OF MAN — At the hand of one who kills with premeditation, when there are no witnesses to the murder, will "I" require it.*

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

מיד איש אחיו.

שֶׁהוּא אוֹהֵב לוֹ כְּאָח וְהָרַג שׁוֹגֵג, אֲנִי אֶדְרֹשׁ אִם לֹא יִגְלֶה וִיבַקֵּשׁ עַל עֲוֹנוֹ לִמָּחֵל, שֶׁאַף הַשּׁוֹגֵג צָרִיךְ כַּפָּרָה,

מיד איש אחיו *AT THE HAND OF EVERY MAN'S BROTHER — At the hand of a man who loves him like a brother and slays him accidentally will "I" require it, unless he go into banishment (in one of the Cities of Refuge) and pray for forgiveness for his iniquity.*

וְאִם אֵין עֵדִים לְחַיְּבוֹ גָּלוּת וְהוּא אֵינוֹ נִכְנָע, הַקָּבָ"ה דּוֹרֵשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ,

For even one who kills another by accident needs atonement:

כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ רַבּוֹתֵינוּ "וְהָאֱלֹקִים אִנָּה לְיָדוֹ" בְּמַסֶּכֶת מַכּוֹת

therefore if there are no witnesses to the deed to make him liable to banishment and he does not humble himself, the Holy One, blessed be He, will require it of him, just as our Rabbis explain the text, (Exodus 21:13) "But God causes it to come to hand", in Treatise Makkot (Makkot 10b):

הַקָּבָ"ה מְזַמְּנָן לְפֻנְדָּק אֶחָד וְכוּ':

The Holy One, blessed be He, causes them (the man who killed by accident and had not expiated the murder and the man who killed with premeditation) to meet at the same inn.

The former in ascending a ladder falls upon the latter and kills him and has therefore — the accident having been seen by men — to go to banishment.

באדם דמו ישפך.

אִם יֵשׁ עֵדִים הֲמִיתוּהוּ אַתֶּם, לָמָּה? כִּי בְצֶלֶם אֱלֹקִים וגו':

באדם דמו ישפך *BY MAN SHALL HIS BLOOD BE SHED — If there are witnesses you kill him.*

Why?

Because in the image of God [made He man] and he has destroyed the Divine image (Genesis Rabbah 34:14)

עשה את האדם.

זֶה מִקְרָא חָסֵר, וְצָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת עָשָׂה הָעוֹשֶׂה אֶת הָאָדָם וְכֵן הַרְבֵּה בַּמִּקְרָא:

עשה את האדם *HE MADE MAN — This verse is abbreviated and should be "the Maker made man";*

there are many similar expressions in the Scriptures.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

ואתם פרו ורבו.

לְפִי פְּשׁוּטוֹ הָרְאשׁוֹנָה לִבְרָכָה וְכָאן לְצַוּוּי.

ואתם פרו ורבו *AND YE, BE FRUITFUL AND MULTIPLY — According to the real sense, the first time this was said to man (Genesis 9:1) it was said as a blessing (an assurance that they would be fruitful);*

וּלְפִי מִדְרָשׁוֹ לְהַקִּישׁ מִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ עוֹסֵק בִּפְרִיָּה וּרְבִיָּה לְשׁוֹפֵךְ דָּמִים (יבמות ס"ג):

here it is a command (Ketubot 5a).

According to the Midrashic explanation this command is mentioned here after the mention of murder in order to liken one who abstains from having children to one who sheds blood (Yevamot 63b).

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three source-moves

On "מנעריו" (8:21) Rashi seizes the defective spelling — written without the vav — to read "from his being shaken" (משננער): from the moment the embryo bestirs itself to leave its mother's womb, the evil inclination is implanted (Bereshit Rabbah 34:10). A tight paraphrase of the Midrash, hung on a single missing letter.

On the doubled "ולא אסף ...לא אסף" he hears an oath: repetition is swearing, and this is the oath Isaiah means by "אשר נשבעתי מעבר מי נח" (54:9) — "we do not find any oath there except this doubling," citing the Sages' derasha in Shevuot explicitly. And on "וחתכם" (9:2) he stages the pivot himself: peshat first — "your dread," like Job's "תראו חתת" — then "ואגדה לשון חיות," the aggadah reading dread as vitality: while even a day-old baby lives no one guards it from mice, but dead Og needs guarding (Shabbat 151b).

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words with journeys through the dictionary of the Hebrew language — where each is first seen, how it travels the centuries, and where it lands in this aliyah. (CAL, the Comprehensive Aramaic Lexicon at cal.huc.edu, prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.)

אָדַם

Jastrow · אדם

— , v. הדם. [v. Rabb. D. S. to Ab. Zar. 38ᵇ, Bets. 24ᵇ, note.]

Jastrow · אדם

— , v. דמם) [to be viscous, thick, dark] to be red, grow red.

Jastrow · אדם

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

— m. (b. h.) man, pr. n. m. Adam, frequ. א׳ הראשון (abbr. ר"אה). Gen. R. s. 17; a. fr.—ספרו של דאה, ספרא אה"ר ר"ר the (allegorical) book of Adam containing all generations and their leaders from beginning to resurrection, i.

Maagarim

אדם — 37572 attestations, root אדם 3 (אדם — man, human being).

First seen in Genesis 1:26-27 — "ויברא אלקים את האדם ...נעשה אדם בצלמנו" — the opening page of 32,209 citations is entirely Genesis (Maagarim: אדם, root אדם 3, 37,572 occurrences). Page 1 also carries this aliyah's own verses, Gen 9:5-6: "שפך דם האדם." The word then travels through a massive Talmudic and midrashic core — 13,431 citations, nearly 9,000 from the first six centuries alone — and a medieval burst (7,642 between 800 and 1100, Geonic and Karaite literature prominent). It lands in Shami's 1937 prose as "בני האדם" and "דמות אדם" — everyman. From the created one to everyman: the word that names this aliyah's covenant partner ("ואני הנני מקים את בריתי אתכם") carries 32,000 citations of humanity thinking about itself.

אֱלֹקִים

Jastrow · אלקים

— , v. אלוה

Klein · אלקים

m.n. pl.

— God (pl. of majesty).

BDB · אלקים

— n.m.pl. (f. 1 K 11:33; on number of occurrences of אל, אלוה, אלקים cf. also Nesl.c.)

Maagarim

אלקים — 18278 attestations, root אלה 1 (אל — the divine name, God).

First seen in the dictionary's first citation of all: "בראשית ברא אלקים" (Maagarim: אלקים, root אלה 1, 18,278 occurrences, 15,488 citations). The biblical density is the highest of any entry — 2,602 in Mikra at relative density 0.87. But the striking cluster is liturgical: פיוט ותפילה, 4,007 citations, the single largest genre — the name under which the world is made becomes the name under which Jews pray. It lands in Shami's 1937 prose glossing Arabic אללה ("ידיד אלקים"), a translatable word for God. In this aliyah אלקים is the name that speaks and blesses (8:15, 9:1) — the name of authority, traveling from creation to liturgy to translation.

אַרְעָא

Jastrow · ארעא

f.

— (רע, h. q. v.) [the brittle] land, earth, ground, field. Targ. Gen. I, 1. Targ. Y. Gen. XVI, 5; a. fr.—B. Bath. 29ᵃ חדא א׳ one field; v. באגא.—Bekh. 25ᵇ דחשוכא א׳ a land of darkness (Babylon); a. fr.—Sabb. 65ᵃ בת א׳

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Firstborns and floods, houses and holy dues

Wednesday, 14 October 2026 · Aliyah 4/7 (Genesis 8:15-9:7) · Daf Bekhorot 26

Jastrow · ארעא

m.

— (ארע I) accident, occurrence. Targ. Ruth II, 3.—[*Pl. ארעייא evils, diseases. Targ. Y. Deut. XXVIII, 60 (prob. to be read מרעיא).]

Klein · ארעא

f.n.

Onkelos's word for earth — Jastrow: ארעא, '(the brittle) land, earth, ground, field,' Targum Genesis 1:1 for Hebrew ארץ. It appears eight times in this aliyah's Targum, doing quiet work: where the Hebrew says הארץ the Aramaic says ארעא, and the land that was cursed (8:21) is the same ארעא that must now be filled (9:1, 9:7). From Targum to Talmud the word stays put — Bekhorot's own daf speaks of ארעא דחשוכא, 'a land of darkness' — and survives into modern idiom as the earth beneath the text. (Maagarim swept the Hebrew terms; this Aramaic one rests on Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.)

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr